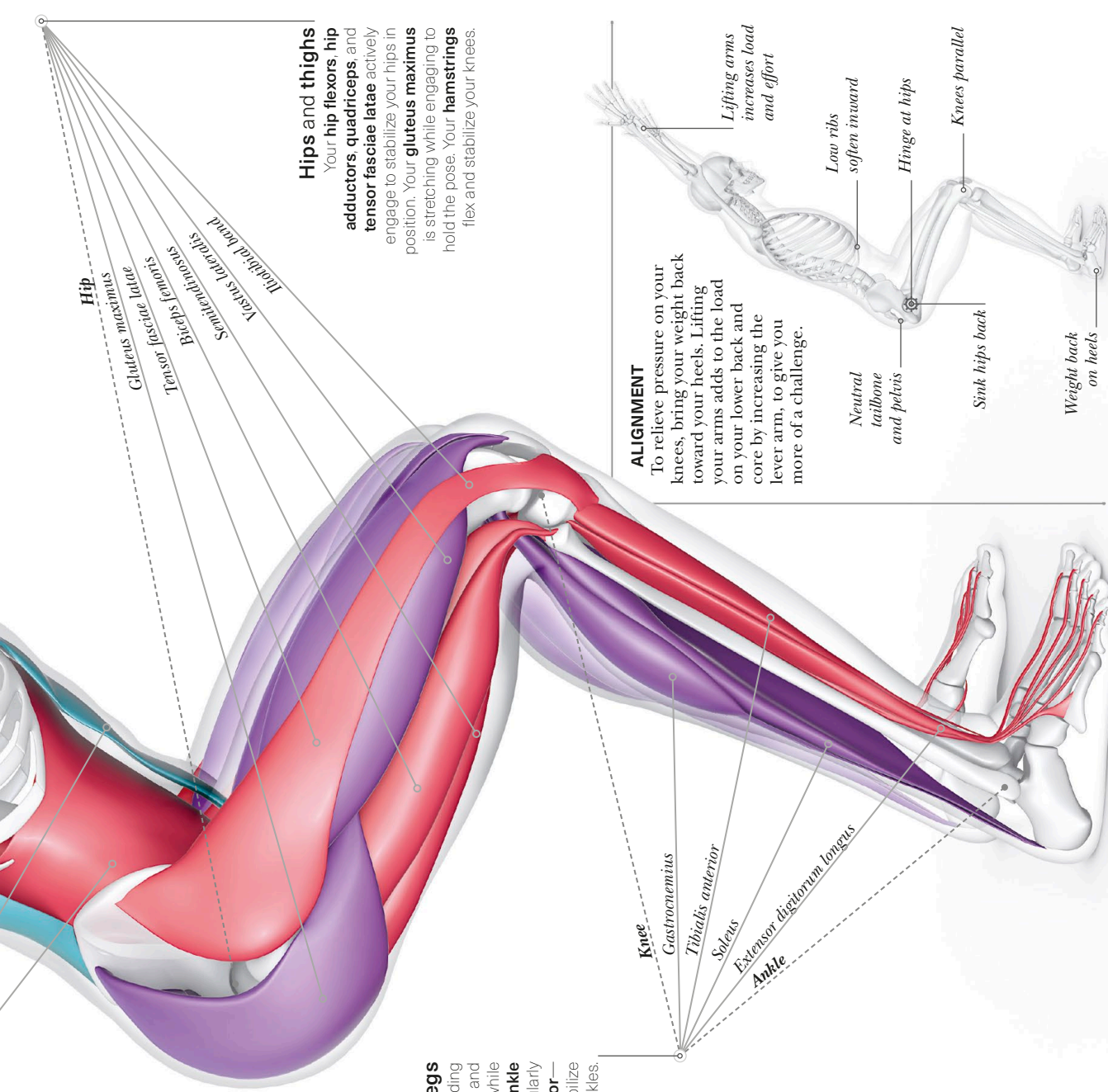




Hips and thighs
 Your **hip flexors**, **hip adductors**, **quadriceps**, and **tensor fasciae latae** actively engage to stabilize your hips in position. Your **gluteus maximus** is stretching while engaging to hold the pose. Your **hamstrings** flex and stabilize your knees.

Lower legs
 Your **calf muscles**—including your **gastrocnemius** and **soleus**—engage while lengthened. Your **ankle dorsiflexors**—particularly your **tibialis anterior**—engage to strongly stabilize your feet and ankles.

ALIGNMENT

To relieve pressure on your knees, bring your weight back toward your heels. Lifting your arms adds to the load on your lower back and core by increasing the lever arm, to give you more of a challenge.

KEY

- Joints
- Muscles
- Engaging
- Engaging while stretching
- Stretching